

IN COLLABORATION WITH

Villanova University- Cultural Studies

Global Interdisciplinary Studies

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WORLD MARXIST REVIEW



2023

SPINE

**THE SOCIETY FOR PEACE,
INTERNATIONALISM, AND ECOLOGY**

ABOUT SPINE

The Society for Peace, Internationalism & Ecology (SPINE) provides a platform for rigorous scholarly research, cultural work, and organizing that stands up for peace, international solidarity, and environmental sustainability. It encourages innovative work that has real use-value for collective struggles and contributes to developing collaborative intellectual, artistic, and activist communities across Turtle Island and around the world. Rather than being restricted to particular fields or limited to those working in academic institutions, SPINE is resolutely transdisciplinary and encourages extra-academic scholarship, as well as contributions from artists and activists.

SPINE does not take a neutral stance on global struggles or pretend to be value-free. Instead, it explicitly upholds and defends the values of international solidarity and environmental justice. It rejects all forms of social chauvinism, racism, misogyny, homophobia, and other types of oppression, while simultaneously recognizing that they cannot be fully overcome without going to their class and colonial roots. It thereby provides a space for materialist research, cultural production, and organizing that contributes to the goals of substantive social transformation in the direction of a more egalitarian, peaceful, and sustainable world.

SPINE hosts an annual conference and supports other activities through the course of the year. Its founding co-sponsors are the [Critical Theory Workshop](#), [Iskra Books](#), and the [World Marxist Review](#).

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WELCOME

The Organizing Committee would like to welcome you to the second annual conference of the Society for Peace, Internationalism and Ecology (SPINE).

We created SPINE as a platform for rigorous and principled intellectual and cultural work. This year, our presenters will offer crucial analysis of the history of social movements, the cascading crises facing the planet today, and the prospects for internationalist class struggle in the period ahead.

The guiding principle of SPINE is simple: we exist to promote art, scholarship, and other intellectual work that has real use value in the struggle against imperialism. We embrace a dialectical and materialist approach to social phenomena, one that understands the interconnected crises we face today in relation to imperialism and a global economic order organized at the expense of working-class and oppressed people internationally, who constitute the vast majority of the world's population.

We embrace socialism as the only path forward for humanity to save ourselves and the planet. We look forward to building with you all during this weekend of learning, dialogue, and solidarity!

KEYNOTE

Dr Helen Yaffe is a professor of Latin American Political Economy at the University of Glasgow. Since 1995, she has spent time living and researching in Cuba and participating in solidarity campaigns. Her doctoral research examined the least known aspect of one of the 20th century's best-known icons: the economic work of Ernesto 'Che' Guevara as a member of the Cuban government and his contribution to socialist political economy debates. Her books on Cuba have become set texts in Cuba studies.

Her most recent book is *We Are Cuba! How a Revolutionary People Have Survived in a Post-Soviet World* (Yale University Press, 2020). She also published *Che Guevara: the Economics of Revolution* (Palgrave Macmillan, 2009). Yaffe is also co-author with Professor Gavin Brown of the book *Youth Activism and Solidarity: the Non-Stop Picket against Apartheid* (2017). She has co-produced two documentaries: *Cuba & Covid-19: Public Health, Science and Solidarity* (2020) and *Cuba's Life Task: Combatting Climate Change* (2021).



PROGRAM

OCT 2

Villanova University

800 E. Lancaster Ave, Villanova, PA 19085

Accessibility: Wheelchair accessible entrance and parking lot available

Driscoll Hall: Larson Auditorium (Room 132)

8:00–9:00 AM

Coffee + Tea

9:00–9:15 AM

Opening Remarks

9:15–10:45 AM

Imperialist War

- Effectiveness as Empire: Hugh J. Davis, the Dalkon Shield, and the Imperial Biopolitics of Reproductive Control (Sophie Widmer)
- The Inverted Logic of Forever War: Destruction In and For Itself (Alex Barnett)
- International Law as Battlefield and Weapon in the Vietnamese Struggle for Liberation (Grace Balchin)

11:00–12:30 PM

Sites of Anti-Imperialist Struggle on the Korean Peninsula (members of Nodutdol)

- Betsy Yoon
- Jia Hong
- Huay Din

12:30–2:00 PM

Lunch

2:00–3:30 PM

Histories of Class Struggle

- Revolutionary possibilities – Lessons from the League of Revolutionary Black Workers (League) for Today's Class War (Walda Katz-Fishman and Jerome Scott)
- Soviet Nationality Policies in Retrospect and the Importance of the National Question in the 21st Century (Andrey Sovin)
- "'We are pushing': Value, Labour, and Political Organising in the Socialist Party of Zambia" – (Andrew Tang)

3:45–5:45 PM

The American Ghetto

- The Underdevelopment of the American Ghetto: Socialism is the Solution to Mass Incarceration (Chris Alfonso and Steven Powers)
- Racialized Anti-Welfare Hegemony Persists Amidst 2025 Welfare Crisis (Jaden Oates)
- Prisons & the Principal Contradiction: Scientific Prison Theory & Praxis for Organizers and Educators (Eunha Jeong Wood)

6:00 – 6:45 PM

Film Screening: Revolution/Counter-Revolution

- Mtume Gant

PROGRAM

OCT 3

Villanova University

800 E. Lancaster Ave, Villanova, PA 19085

Accessibility: Wheelchair accessible entrance and parking lot available

Driscoll Hall: Larson Auditorium (Room 132)

Nikki Lopez

304 South St, Philadelphia, PA 19147

8:00–9:00 AM

Coffee + Tea

9:00–10:30 AM

Psychology and Pedagogy

- Toward a Marxist-Leninist Approach to Psychotherapy (Mackenzie Stocum)
- Sex, Screens, and Citizenship: The Psychopolitics of the Passport Bro Movement (Azura Lê Haynes)
- A Pedagogy for Revolution: Revisiting Paulo Freire (Scott Ritchie)

10:45–12:15 PM

Communication

- Building a Socialist Communication System: Lessons from Ghana (Shinjoung Yeo)
- Cabral's Ecological Anti-Imperialist Theory of Cultural Development (Jared Bly)
- The Pre-Marxist "Species Being": A Venn Diagram of Marx and Indigenous Philosophy (Tiffany Montoya)

12:15–1:15 PM

Lunch

1:15–2:45 PM

Cuba

- Doves, Dialectics, and Revolution: Interspecies Encounter in the Cuban Revolutionary Imaginary (Asia Meana)
- The Development of Fidel Castro's Ecosocial Thought (Alejandro Pedregal)
- Revolutionary Love and Cuba in the Construction of a Multipolar World (Matthew Monteiro)

3:00–4:30 PM

(Counter-) Revolution

- Cold War 2.0? Pro-Israeli Bollywood in the Era of Modi (Ankita Rathour)
- Blood, Soil, and Saffron: Mapping the Contours of Hindu Eco-fascism in India (Pratik Raghu)
- Arts-based approach to community health promotion: Street theatre skits in the tradition of India's cultural worker, artist, and playwright – Safdar Hashmi (Anna Mullany)

4:45 – 6:15 PM

Keynote

- Helen Yaffe

6:15–6:30 PM

Closing Remarks

8:00 PM –

Social at Nikki Lopez